

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Computers keep us connected to the world!



Learning Outcome

Understand detailed descriptions of real or imaginary events and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts.

Ask your partner:

- How computer literate are you?
- How long have you been using your computer to access different sites?
- How would you feel if you had no access to one?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology and personal dilemmas.
- I can talk about likely situations using *if* or *unless*.
- I can identify and express the main ideas of a text.





Let's Explore!

What is the digital **divide***?

* A "divide" is a separation.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

What exactly is the digital divide? It is an economic and social equality tied to the ability to have access to information and communication technology. This means computers and Internet connectivity. In the US this divide may be between households, businesses or geographic areas. Globally, it refers to the technological gap between developing and developed countries. You can't keep up unless you are connected.

In the beginning, when North America and Europe moved to a more computer and Internet-based life, they left everyone who was not connected behind, both within their borders and without. If you don't have access in this scenario, what will you do? Many had to survive without.

North Americans found computers where they could. They were encouraged to buddy up with someone with a computer to do schoolwork. As levels of connectivity grew, more women, racial and ethnic minorities, lower-income and rural residents, and less educated people gained access. They seemed to catch up, at least in the short term.

Recent studies now look at the digital divide in terms of bandwidth. DSL, cable modems and Wi-Fi increased the level of inequality once again. "How?" you may wonder. If these weren't only available to a portion of society to begin with, they would not. Unless the price of these innovations comes down, they will remain forever out of reach.

It will be surprising if this doesn't continue as each new item is rolled out for consumption. The truth is, that unless people have the money to pay for access, know how to use the tools and understand the information available, they will always remain behind.

So, the divide persists. If it wasn't the outcome we wanted, it is still what we have, at least for now. Let's hope things change.





Let's Practice!

Peter talks about what the digital divide is.

Instructions: Choose the option that best completes the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) The digital divide is related to the economic and social _____ that is tied to access to information and communication technology.
a) equality b) equilibrium c) equal
- 2) The digital divide refers to the technological _____ between developing and developed countries.
a) area b) space c) gap
- 3) If you don't have access in this scenario, what will you do? Many had to survive _____ it.
a) alone b) without c) unless ap
- 4) North Americans were encouraged to _____ with someone with a computer to do schoolwork.
a) body up b) buddy c) buddy up
- 5) Unless the price of these innovations comes down, they will remain forever _____.
a) out of reach b) far away c) far



Let's Practice!

Unless everyone has access to the Internet, there will be a digital divide.

Instructions: Choose words from the box to correctly complete the sentences. There are three options that you don't need to use.

Word Bank

If you don't / Unless / unless some people / Unless the price / If it / up unless / If / unless people

- 1) You can't keep _____ you are connected.
- 2) _____ have access in this scenario, what will you do?
- 3) _____ of these innovations comes down, they will remain forever out of reach.
- 4) The truth is, that _____ have money to pay for access, know how to use the tools and understand the information available, they will always remain behind.
- 5) _____ wasn't the outcome we wanted, it still what we have, at least for now.



Extension Activity

Do a survey on digital devices and use.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 10 question survey about digital devices people have.
- Find out about the types of cell phones, computers, printers, notebooks and Internet service people have.
- Also find out how much the devices are used, how long they are used per day and by whom.
- Ask 10 to 15 people all of the questions.
- Combine your results with a partner's results.
- Write sentences to report your findings in percentages.
- Share your results with the class.
- Decide as a group whether or not there are any digital divides.



Target Words

- equality** (noun): the right of different groups of people to receive the same treatment
e.g. It is an economic and social equality tied to the ability to have access to information and communication technology.
- to tie to** (verb): to be related to
e.g. It is an economic and social equality tied to the ability to have access to information and communication technology.
- technological gap** (noun): the difference between the technology you have and the technology you need
e.g. Globally, it refers to the technological gap between developing and developed countries.
- without** (noun): beyond; outside of
e.g. They left everyone not connected behind, both within their borders and without.
- to buddy up** (verb): to partner with
e.g. They were encouraged to buddy up with someone with a computer to do schoolwork.
- connectivity** (noun): ability to connect
e.g. As levels of connectivity grew, more women, racial and ethnic minorities, lower income and rural residents, and less educated people gained access.
- minority** (noun): small group of people who share some characteristic by birth
e.g. Ethnic minorities, lower income and rural residents, and less educated people gained access.
- rural** (adjective): located away from cities
e.g. Rural residents and less educated people gained access.
- out of reach** (expression): unavailable
e.g. They will remain forever out of reach.
- bandwidth** (noun): the amount of information that can be sent over a network connection at one time
e.g. Recent studies now look at the digital divide in terms of bandwidth.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a 10 question survey about digital devices.

☐ ☐

I find out how much the devices are used, how long they are used per day and by whom.

☐ ☐

I combine my results with a partner's results.

☐ ☐

We write sentences to report your findings in percentages.

☐ ☐

We share the findings with the class.

☐ ☐

We come to a consensus as to whether or not there are any digital divides.

☐ ☐



Learning Points

If vs. Unless in the Real Conditional

You use the Real Conditional to express events or situations that are likely to happen.

You use *If* or *unless* to express conditions for the events to occur.

Unless is used in conditional sentences as a necessary condition without which the outcome of the sentence can't happen.

Example:

You can't keep up unless you are connected.

If ... not is used when the outcome in the *if* clause is unexpected or in questions.

Examples:

It will be surprising if this doesn't continue.

If you don't have access to the Internet, what will you do?

Examples:

- *You can't keep up unless you are connected.*
- *If you don't have access in this scenario, what will you do?*
- *Unless the price of these innovations comes down, they will remain forever out of reach.*
- *It will be surprising if this doesn't continue as each new item is rolled out for consumption.*





Learning Points

Identifying the Main Ideas of a Text

When you read a text, it's important to identify the main ideas that you find.

When you want to identify the main ideas of a text, try to answer the following questions:

- *What/Who?*

What or who is the text talking about?

- *How?*

How does the text convey its message?

- *When/Where/Why?*

What are the details or supporting arguments that you can find in the text?

Read the following paragraph and notice how the expressions in bold answer these questions.

Examples:

- **What exactly is the digital divide?** (what?)
- *It is an economic and social equality tied to the ability to have access **to information and communication technology.*** (what?)
- *This means computers and Internet connectivity. **In the US.** this divide may be between households, businesses or geographic areas. Globally, it refers to the technological gap **between developing and developed countries.*** (where?)
- **You can't keep up** unless you are connected. (who?)
- **In the beginning,** when North America and Europe moved to a more computer and Internet-based life, **they left everyone not connected behind, both within their borders and without.** (when?/who?/where?)

